Creative Brief Template · Expert version

A creative brief template gives designers, writers and agencies everything they need to do great work first time: the objective, audience, single key message, tone, deliverables, mandatories, budget and deadlines.

How to use this template

1. Write the objective and audience first.
2. Distil the single key message and supporting proof.
3. List deliverables, formats and mandatories.
4. Add budget, timeline, review dates and the approver.
5. Brief the team in person and invite questions.

Tips

- One message per brief.
- Describe what the audience thinks now and what you want them to think.
- Include examples of what you like and dislike.
- Agree review rounds up front.

Creative brief · Agree the brief before creative work starts

Section	Prompt	Your answer
Project name		Spring launch campaign
Background	What's happening and why now?	
Objective	What should this work achieve?	500 qualified leads
Target audience	Who are we talking to? What do they think now?	Operations managers at mid-size firms
Single key message	The one thing they should remember.	
Reasons to believe	Proof points.	
Tone of voice	How should it feel?	Confident, practical, friendly
Deliverables and formats	Sizes, channels, quantities.	
Mandatories	Logos, legal lines, brand rules.	
Budget		
Timeline and review dates		
Approver	Who signs off?	